

PANDA Collaborator

Setup & Daily Use Guide

● Darrin · User 1 · Amber theme

● Pam · User 2 · Cyan theme

PANDA Collaborator helps Darrin and Pam share an AI coding workspace safely. When one person finishes and the other takes over, PANDA creates a safe handoff record so nothing is lost. First-time setup takes about 3 minutes and is done once. Daily use takes about 30 seconds.

Part	Title	When to use
1	First-Time Setup	Once only — registers Darrin and Pam
2	Daily Use	Every session — 30 seconds
3	Creating a Handoff	When you finish working
4	Troubleshooting	If something goes wrong

Part 1 — First-Time Setup

Do this once on each computer that runs PANDA Collaborator. After you finish, the Hub will open automatically every time.

1

Open PANDA Collaborator

Double-click the PANDA Collaborator icon on your Desktop. Your browser opens automatically within a few seconds. The address is `http://127.0.0.1:8788/`.

The app runs entirely on your computer — nothing is sent to the internet just because you open it.

2

Register Darrin (User 1)

The registration form opens automatically on first launch. Fill in Darrin's details below. Most fields are pre-filled — you only need to type the name.

PANDA Collaborator Setup — Register Users

Register Darrin

Name	(type here)	Type your name here
Repo path	C:\CODEX PG	
Handoff agent	Codex	Pre-filled
Handoff title	Darrin handoff	
Codex account	Codex (Darrin)	
Claude account	Claude (Darrin)	
Claude Desktop	C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Local\AnthropicClaude\claude.exe	
Claude Code	C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Roaming\npm\claude.CMD	
Git name	Codex Backup	
Git email	codex-backup@local	

Register User 1 and continue →

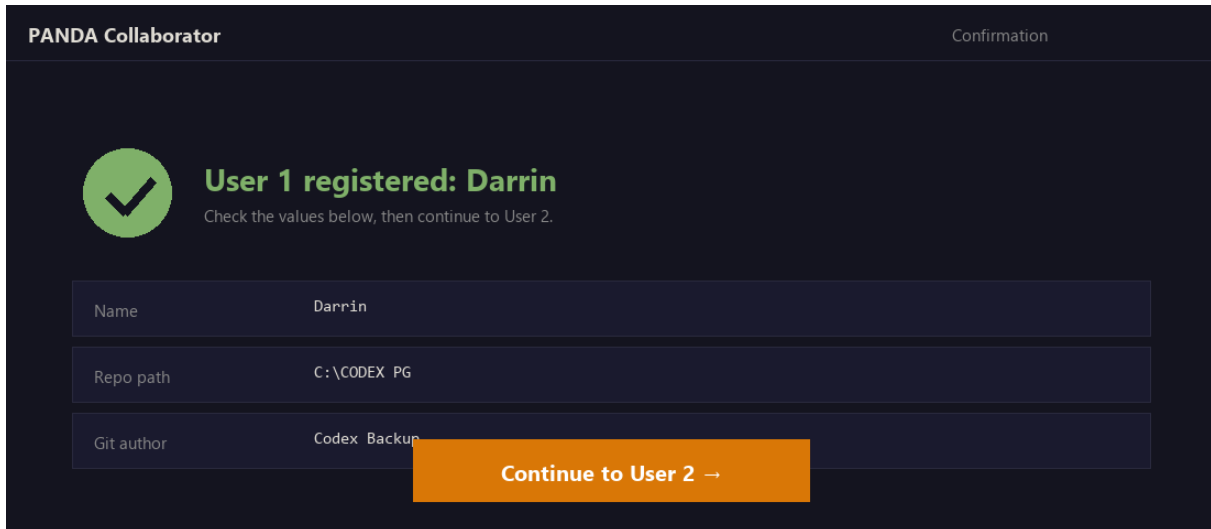
Click to register

If the Register button is grey, scroll down — a required field may be below the visible area. The footer shows which fields are missing.

3

See the Confirmation

PANDA shows a confirmation screen with Darrin's saved details. Check that everything looks right, then click **Continue to User 2**.



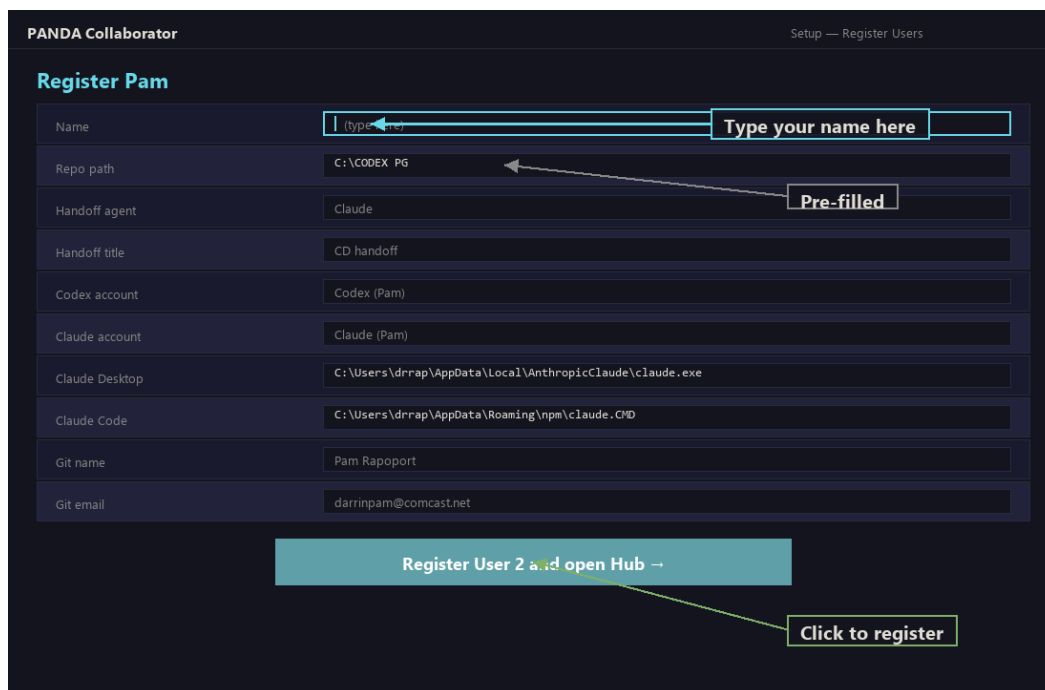
The screenshot shows the 'PANDA Collaborator' interface with a 'Confirmation' header. A green checkmark icon is next to the text 'User 1 registered: Darrin'. Below this, a message says 'Check the values below, then continue to User 2.' There are three input fields: 'Name' with 'Darrin', 'Repo path' with 'C:\CODEX PG', and 'Git author' with 'Codex Backup'. An orange button labeled 'Continue to User 2 →' is at the bottom.

Field	Value
Name	Darrin
Repo path	C:\CODEX PG
Git author	Codex Backup

4

Register Pam (User 2)

The same form appears for Pam. Fill in Pam's details. Pam's row uses cyan accents instead of amber — that's how the app shows which user is being set up.



The screenshot shows the 'PANDA Collaborator' interface with a 'Setup — Register Users' header. The title is 'Register Pam'. There are ten input fields: 'Name' (with a placeholder '(Type here)' and a callout 'Type your name here'), 'Repo path' (with 'C:\CODEX PG' and a callout 'Pre-filled'), 'Handoff agent' (with 'Claude'), 'Handoff title' (with 'CD handoff'), 'Codex account' (with 'Codex (Pam)'), 'Claude account' (with 'Claude (Pam)'), 'Claude Desktop' (with 'C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Local\AnthropicClaude\claude.exe'), 'Claude Code' (with 'C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Roaming\npm\claude.cmd'), 'Git name' (with 'Pam Rapoport'), and 'Git email' (with 'darrinpam@comcast.net'). A teal button labeled 'Register User 2 and open Hub →' is at the bottom, with a callout 'Click to register' pointing to it.

Field	Value
Name	(Type here)
Repo path	C:\CODEX PG
Handoff agent	Claude
Handoff title	CD handoff
Codex account	Codex (Pam)
Claude account	Claude (Pam)
Claude Desktop	C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Local\AnthropicClaude\claude.exe
Claude Code	C:\Users\drrap\AppData\Roaming\npm\claude.cmd
Git name	Pam Rapoport
Git email	darrinpam@comcast.net

Once both users are registered, the Hub opens automatically. You won't need to register again.

Part 2 — Daily Use

Every time you open PANDA Collaborator, follow these steps. The whole thing takes about 30 seconds.

1

Open PANDA Collaborator

Double-click the desktop icon. Your browser opens the Hub.

2

Click the Handover button for the active user

Inside the User 1 (Darrin) or User 2 (Pam) card, click **Handover**. PANDA switches the colour theme and loads that person's settings.

3

Confirm the name at the top of the screen

The large name at the top shows who is active. Amber = Darrin. Cyan = Pam. Always check this before starting work.

4

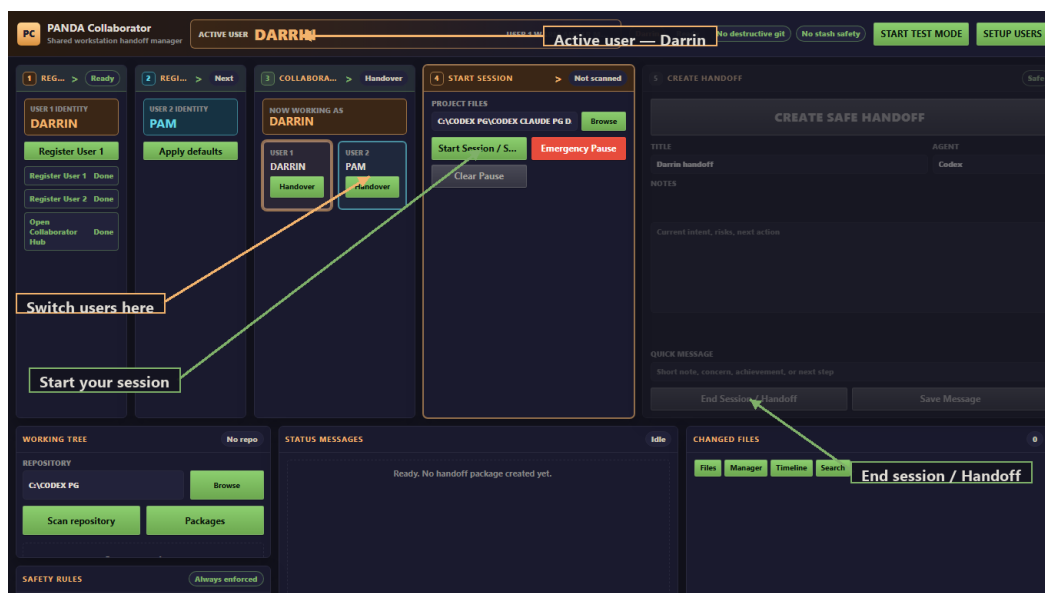
Click Start Session / Start Work

PANDA scans the project and shows a plain-English summary of what happened last time — concerns, achievements, and what to do next. Read it before starting.

5

Do your work, then return to PANDA when done

Work in Claude, Codex, or any other tool. Come back to PANDA when you finish.



The Collaborator Hub with Darrin active (amber theme). The other user's Handover button is always visible — one click switches the active user.

Part 3 — Creating a Handoff

When you finish working, create a handoff so the next person has full context.

1

Click End Session / Handoff

Find this button in the Collaborator Hub. Click it.

2

Enter a short title (optional)

Describe what you did — for example: *Tracker filter fix, combo UX done*. Leave blank to use the default.

3

Add notes (optional)

Briefly note what you finished, any open issues, and what to do next.

4

Click Create safe handoff

PANDA saves a protection branch, patch files for unsaved changes, file copies, and a plain-English HANDOFF summary.

5 CREATE HANDOFF

CREATE SAFE HANDOFF

TITLE AGENT

CD handoff Claude

NOTES

Current intent, risks, next action

QUICK MESSAGE

Short note, concern, achievement, or next step

End Session / Handoff Save Message

The Create Handoff form. Fill in the title and any notes, then click the button. PANDA handles the rest.

PANDA never deletes files, force-pushes, or discards unsaved work. It is always safe to click Create safe handoff.

Part 4 — Troubleshooting

[!]

Something looks wrong — click Emergency Pause

Click the red Emergency Pause button. This stops all work and flags the issue. Nothing is deleted.

[?]

The browser didn't open

Double-click the desktop icon again. If it still won't open, type `http://127.0.0.1:8788/` into your browser.

[>]

The app says it is already running

That's fine. Open your browser and go to `http://127.0.0.1:8788/`

[o]

A button is grey and won't click

A required field is missing. For registration buttons, scroll down inside the form — some fields may be below the visible area. The footer names missing fields.

[P]

Reading an old handoff

Click **Packages** in the left panel, pick a package, then click **Inspect package**. Read-only — no files are changed.

[W]

Never enter passwords into PANDA

PANDA stores names and email addresses only. Never type passwords, API keys, or tokens.

Quick Reference

Task	What to do	Where
Open the app	Double-click PANDA Collaborator on the Desktop	Desktop
App won't open	Go to http://127.0.0.1:8788/ in your browser	Browser
Switch to Darrin	Click Handover in User 1 card, then check name at top	Hub
Switch to Pam	Click Handover in User 2 card, then check name at top	Hub
Start working	Click Start Session / Start Work	Hub
Finish working	Click End Session / Handoff, then Create safe handoff	Hub
Something is wrong	Click Emergency Pause (red button)	Hub
Read old handoffs	Click Packages, pick one, click Inspect package	Hub left panel
App already running	Open browser, go to http://127.0.0.1:8788/	Browser